

Callery Pear

Pyrus calleryana



Origin

Native to China and Vietnam; introduced to the US in 1917 by plant explorer Frank Meyer as rootstock to help fight a disease affecting European pear orchards.

Look for

Its synchronized, all-at-once white spring bloom -- often before any leaves appear -- makes it one of the most visually striking street trees for about a week each April.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Flower: clouds of white five-petaled flowers bloom all at once in early spring, before leaves emerge.
- Leaf: glossy, rounded leaf with wavy, finely toothed edges.
- Fall color: often the last tree on the block to change, turning deep red-purple.
- Commonly confused with: other white-flowering spring trees (callery pear's flowers have an unpleasant, fish-like smell, unlike cherry or crabapple).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Covered in clouds of white five-petaled flowers before leaves emerge.
Summer	Glossy, rounded leaves with wavy edges.
Fall	Leaves turn deep red-purple, often the last tree on the block to change color.
Winter	Tight, narrow branching pattern (in the 'Bradford' cultivar especially).

DID YOU KNOW

- The popular 'Bradford' cultivar was bred to be sterile, but when different callery pear cultivars grow near each other they can cross-pollinate and produce fertile seeds, which is why it's now considered invasive in parts of the eastern US.
- Despite the pretty flowers, they're known for smelling unpleasant -- often compared to fish.